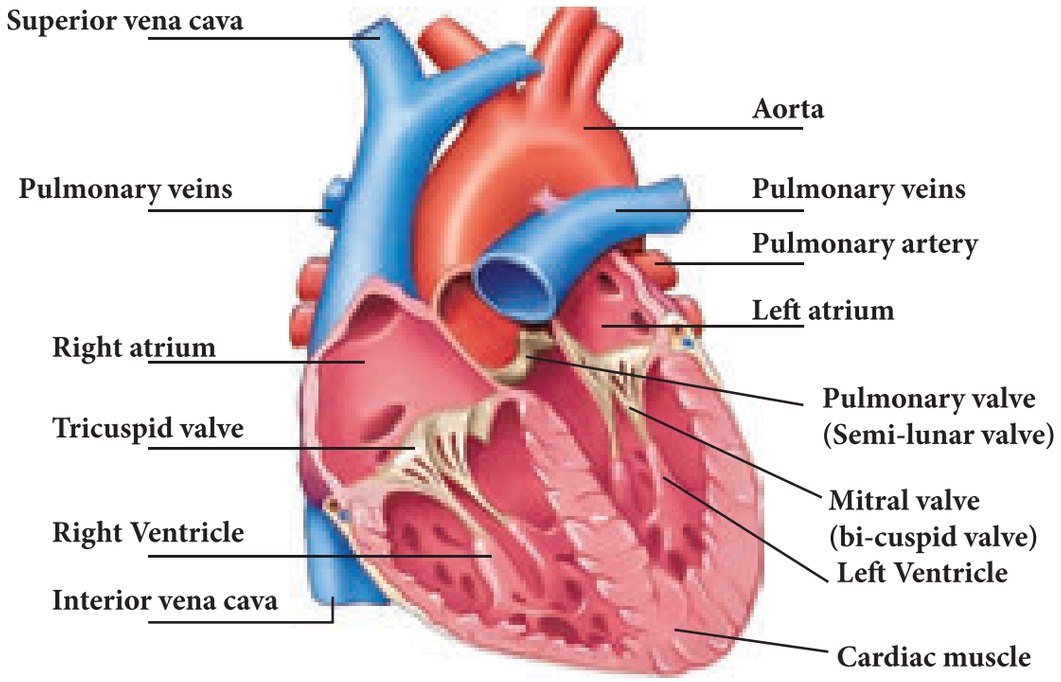
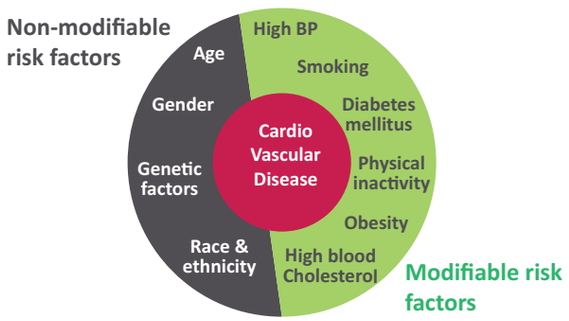


The fatty fibrous mass thickens over time narrowing the interior of the artery and forms blood clots, which may cut off blood flow causing tissue death called an **infarct**. When there is no supply of blood nutrients and oxygen to the myocardium (heart muscle) due to block in one of the coronary arteries, the event is called an acute **myocardial infarction** (MI) or heart attack.

2. **Stroke** / brain attack results when there is a block in the major artery supplying blood to the brain.

Risk factors for CVD

Multiple risk factors are involved such as:



Non-modifiable factors - the individual has no control over them.

1. **Age** - Onset increases with advancing age: usually between 50-55 years occurs at an earlier age in individual with a position family history.
2. **Sex** - Occurs more in men than women: but after menopause the risk increases in a woman due to lack of ovarian hormone estrogen.
3. **Hereditary/ family history** - A history of premature death (before 55 years in a parent/grandparent) increases the risk for CVD.

Modifiable factors - can be controlled to prevent or delay the onset of CVD.

4. **Blood lipids** - Elevated levels of blood lipids (Cholesterol, LDL & triglycerides) is the major risk factor which is worsened by lack of physical activity, obesity, smoking, stress and excess food intake.
5. **Dietary fat**- High intake of saturated fat and cholesterol in the diet increases the blood cholesterol levels.

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